

MR. FANTASTIC

Leader of the Fantastic Four

MR. FANTASTIC

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Reed Richards

OCCUPATION

Scientist, adventurer

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT

6 ft 1 in

WEIGHT

180 lbs

EYES

Brown

HAIR

Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

Fantastic Four #1

(November 1961)

POWERS

A scientific genius, specializing in physics, aeronautics, Mr. Fantastic can stretch, reshape, compress, or expand his entire body or parts of his body into any shape. He can stretch his neck, limbs or torso up to 1,500 feet without pain. He can create a canopy, sheath, umbrella, or parachute with his body.

ALLIES/FOES

ALLIES Susan Storm (Invisible Woman), Ben Grimm (the Thing), Johnny Storm (Human Torch), Lyja the Skrull, Alicia Masters

FOES Gormu, Doctor Doom, Frightful Four, Galactus, Puppet Master, the Skrulls, Annihilus, Blastaar, Diablo

ISSUE #1

In November 1961, *Fantastic Four* #1 ushered in the Marvel Age of Comics and introduced millions to what would become the Marvel Universe. Comic books would never be the same!



He's the leader of one of the world's most important Super Hero teams. He's also a brilliant scientist. Reed Richards is Mr. Fantastic. As leader of the super hero group, the FANTASTIC FOUR, Mr. Fantastic uses both his ability to stretch his body and his sharp scientific mind in his quest to help mankind.

A BRILLIANT STUDENT

The son of highly intelligent parents, Reed Richards was a child prodigy and a brilliant student. His father Nathaniel Richards was a wealthy physicist. Reed's mother, Evelyn, died when the boy was seven years old.

Young Reed showed a genius for math, physics, and mechanics, which his father encouraged. Nathaniel guided his son's scientific studies. By the time Reed was fourteen, he was already taking and excelling in college-level courses. When he reached college age, Reed attended several universities, including Empire State University in New York.

It was there that Reed Richards met several people who would play a major role in his later life as Mr. Fantastic. Victor Von Doom was a foreign student from the nation of Latveria. This scientific genius was assigned to be Reed's first college roommate, but Von Doom disliked Reed from the moment he met him and asked for a new roommate. Later, as DOCTOR DOOM, he would become Mr. Fantastic's and the Fantastic Four's greatest enemy.

Replacing Von Doom as Reed's roommate was Benjamin J. Grimm, a former high school football star who, though very different in personality, became Reed's best friend.

In college, Reed began working on plans to build a ship that could travel to other solar systems. Ben joked that if Reed could build the ship, he would pilot it.

After transferring to Columbia University in Manhattan, Reed rented a room from a woman whose daughter, Susan Storm, immediately fell for Reed. One day she would be his wife, as well as his partner in the Fantastic Four.

A FATEFUL JOURNEY

Using money left to him by his father, Nathaniel, who arranged for the fortune to be given to Reed while Nathaniel was on an alternate

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• Fantastic Four #5

Victor Von Doom blames Reed for the facial scar he receives when a machine explodes. He dons a mask and becomes Doctor Doom, Mr. Fantastic's worst enemy.

• Fantastic Four Annual #6

The cosmic radiation that gave Sue her invisibility power affects her red blood cells, putting her life and the life of her unborn child in danger.



MEANWHILE, IN THE LABORATORY...
IT LOOKS LIKE SOMEONE IS AS ANXIOUS TO SEE THE SCIENCE LAB AS I AM! NAME'S RICHARDS, FELLA. REED RICHARDS!
THAT IS NO CONCERN OF MINE!

Reed Richards' attempt to make friends with fellow student Victor Von Doom were rudely brushed aside.



Mr. Fantastic can stretch his body well over 1,000 feet

Earth, Reed began developing his starship shortly after college. When his own funds began to run out, Reed got funding from the US Federal Government to complete the project.

However, shortly before Reed could complete the ship, the government threatened to cut off funding to the project. Desperate to prove that his starship would fly, Reed decided to take the ship up on a test flight himself. Ben argued against the idea, telling Reed that he thought the ship's shielding would be inadequate against the powerful cosmic radiation found in space.

Reed finally convinced Ben to pilot the ship on its test voyage. By this time, Reed and Sue Storm were engaged. Sue insisted in coming along on the flight, as did her younger brother Johnny

Able to shape his body into a highly malleable state, Mr. Fantastic can stretch his neck to peek around corners, or even look over entire buildings!



AT THE CROSSROADS

Mr. Fantastic floats at the Crossroads of Infinity, where all dimensions and universes intersect. A traveler can journey from one dimension to another by carefully navigating through the Crossroads. Doctor Doom proved this, using the Fantastic Four as his test subjects.

Storm. The quartet snuck onto the launch pad, slipped onto the ship, and blasted off into space. Before they could achieve hyperspace and a journey to another solar system, a solar flare shot intense levels of radiation at the ship. Ben had been right. The ship's shields were not enough to withstand the radiation, which irradiated the four astronauts. Ben was forced to cut short the flight and land back on Earth.

BIG CHANGES

Upon their return to Earth each member of the foursome soon discovered that the cosmic radiation had changed the very structure of their bodies. Reed discovered that he could bend and stretch his body at will. Sue could turn herself invisible. Johnny could cover his body with flames and also fly. Ben's skin was transformed into an orange, rock-like substance, and he gained tremendous strength.

Reed became the team's leader, calling himself Mr. Fantastic. Sue called herself INVISIBLE GIRL

(and later INVISIBLE WOMAN). Johnny called himself the HUMAN TORCH, and Ben called himself the THING. All four agreed to use their new powers to help humanity.

Guided by Reed Richards, the Fantastic Four has become the most respected Super Hero team on Earth. They have saved the planet from conquest and destruction many times. Reed and Sue married and now have two children: Franklin and Valeria Richards.

During the Civil War (see pp. 84-5) Reed sided with IRON MAN and the US government. Sue left him over this, although when the conflict ended, they reunited. Because of his membership in the ILLUMINATI, Reed became a target during World War Hulk (see pp. 152-5). He redeemed himself during the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7). After escaping from the SKRULLS, who had kidnapped and tortured him, he invented a new way to detect them. MT, MF

Mr. Fantastic battles Crucible, a member of the Enclave. Crucible stole Mr. Fantastic's creative genius to launch a genetics program designed to create life itself, but went insane, unable to handle the flood of amazing ideas.

